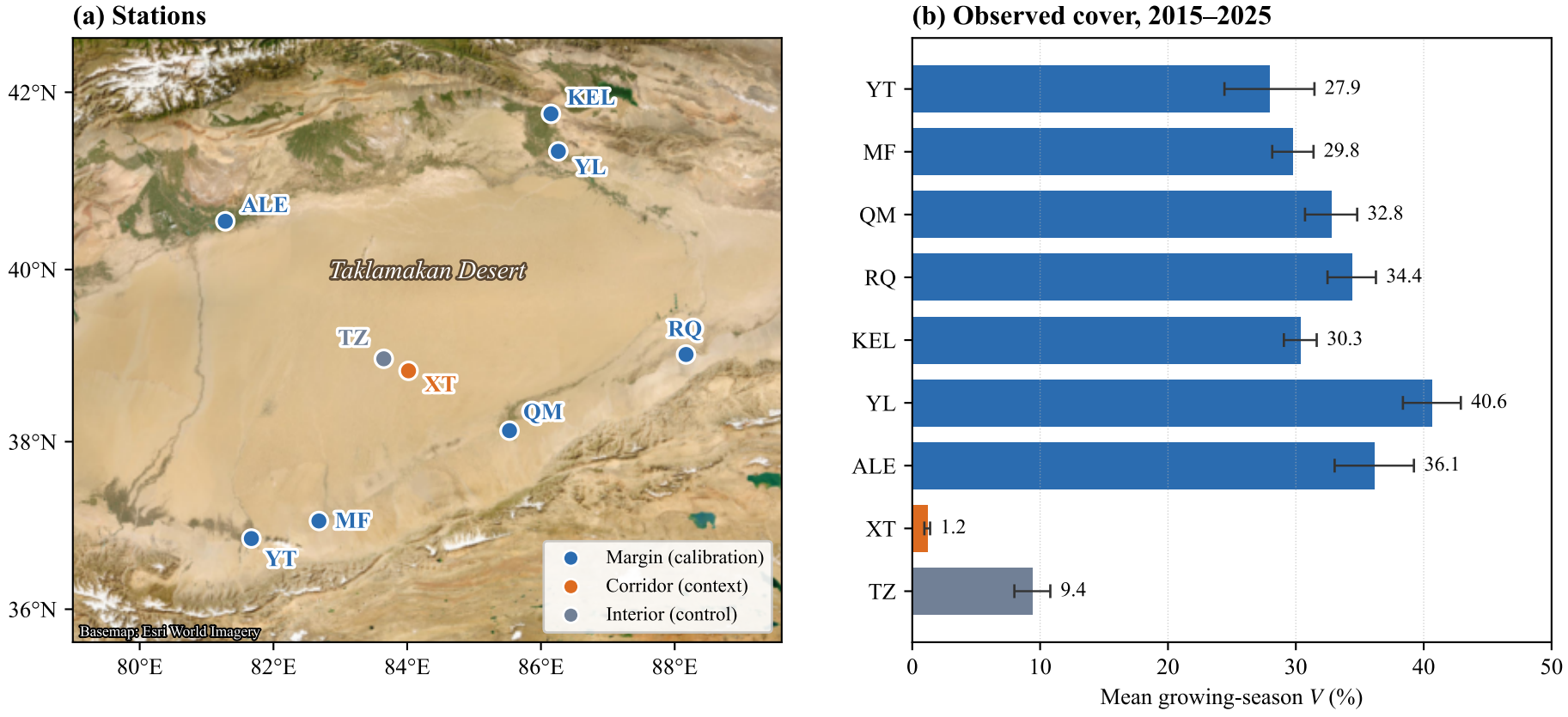

(a) Stations
42°N
40°N
38°N
36°N
80°E
82°E
84°E
86°E
88°E
KEL
YL
ALE
Taklamakan Desert
TZ
XT
RQ
QM
MF
YT
Margin (calibration)
Corridor (context)
Interior (control)
Basemap: Esri World Imagery
(b) Observed cover, 2015–2025
YT
MF
QM
RQ
KEL
YL
ALE
XT
TZ
27.9
29.8
32.8
34.4
30.3
40.6
36.1
1.2
9.4
0
10
20
30
40
50
Mean growing-season V (%)